

High-Level Design Document

Calydon

Version 3.0

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Redacted Version

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1 Calydon Quick Sheet

Big idea

Calydon is an RPG set in the fictional city of Romera, where a new body of believers called the Calydonians have emerged and precipitated a massive conversion of the populace. As a result, tensions between different power groups intensify, culminating in widespread religious strife, violence, and martyrdom.

To maintain order in the city, the Emperor enlists one called Brynn Harrowmage, a notoriously dangerous prisoner of war, to assassinate the fanatical leader of the Calydonians. In exchange, the Emperor promises to grant Brynn and his captive sister freedom to return to the land from which they were captured. You play the game from the perspective of Brynn as you follow multiple leads, fight enemies, solve puzzles, and face moral dilemmas that raise questions about what religious belief really is. Genre

Genre

Calydon draws elements from the puzzle, action-adventure, and role-playing genres.

Category

Calydon is a unique experience that seeks to combine the art and music style of RPGs like *Neverwinter Nights* with challenging puzzles, quests, and religious themes. The selling points of the game are: (a) simple yet polished puzzles and designs; (b) engaging characters and quests; and (c) narrative themes of assassination, death, and religion.

Platform

The primary platform is Windows / PC.

License

Not applicable. The game is not based on any existing films, books, or comics.

Play Mechanic

Players will control Brynn Harrowmage from a third-person perspective as he moves through various locations that comprise the game world. Key components of the gameplay are exploration, combat, and interaction with NPCs. The player will use keyboard and mouse inputs for the controls, as well as conventional RPG mechanics such as acquiring items, leveling up, managing inventory, initiating dialogue encounters, casting spells, and engaging in real-time combat. Key in-game screens to support these play mechanics include:

- Radial Menu – A popup menu that lets players perform actions on game objects or NPCs, such as attacking or casting a spell.
- Quickbar – A bar along the bottom of the main gameplay screen which allows quick access to functions such as selecting items, performing special attacks or abilities, or casting spells.
- Main Gameplay Screen – The primary screen with several distinct sections, including the character portrait, options box, party bar, quickbar, compass, action queue, and status bar.

Moreover, the game will incorporate branching narrative when, at two key junctures in the game, the player will have to make decisions that result in different endings.

Please see Section 7 for more information about the game's interface. Also see Section 11 for more information about the gameplay and controller configuration.

Technology

Calydon will be built with BioWare's Neverwinter Nights™ Aurora Toolset, a robust game engine for making PC-based role-playing games. The toolset includes a tile-based terrain editor, script editor, journal editor, conversation editor, and object palettes filled with pre-rendered yet customizable graphics and sound files such as creatures, NPCs, interiors, place-able objects, encounters, and animation effects.

Target Audience

The target audience for *Calydon* consists of action-adventure / RPG enthusiasts in their mid-teens to the late twenties, especially those interested in games that may be simple from a plot perspective and visual design, but clever and thought-provoking in their puzzles and narratives themes.

Key Features or Unique Selling Points (USPs)

Calydon draws from many conventions in the action-adventure and RPG genres. However, there are several features that will make *Calydon* a fun, unique, and thought-provoking experience:

- Quests, puzzles, and character relationships related to themes that are relatively unexplored in video games, namely, religion and spiritual warfare
- Story ideas, settings, characters, and themes based on the historical events of the early Christian church and the 1st century Roman Empire
- Ability for the player to make meaningful choices at two key points in the game, which will result in different endings

2 Product Overview

Calydon is an action-adventure RPG set in the fictional city of Romera, the capital of the thriving civilized nation of Ambracia. Romera is experiencing what many people call a “cultural genocide” due to the rise of a new body of believers called the Calydonians.

Based on the teaching and miracles of a man named Calydon, the Calydonian faith has emerged as a vibrant system of belief and has spread like fire through a forest, resulting in a massive conversion of the populace. People have left old religious and secular factions to join the new one. As a result, tensions between different power groups arise, culminating in widespread religious and social strife, and even violence, imprisonment, and martyrdom.

One person in particular, Samuel the Healer, has been accused of fomenting violence and sowing the discord the city now witnesses. The last living disciple of Calydon himself, Samuel has been specifically accused of false teachings and magical practices that have provoked angry mobs and upset the city’s social and economic balance.

To quell the spread of Calydonian beliefs and preserve Romera as a beacon of humanism in a world of superstition, the Emperor enlists one called Brynn Harrowmage, a notoriously dangerous prisoner of war, to assassinate Samuel. In exchange, the Emperor promises to release Brynn and his captive sister to Nyssia, the home land from which they were abducted.

The player-character (PC) plays the game from the perspective of Brynn Harrowmage. Early on the PC learns that Brynn is a barbarian noble who was captured during the Nyssian War. Brynn’s father was the King of Nyssia who resisted the Ambracian armies for years, but was later brutally crucified even though he peacefully surrendered. Not surprisingly, Brynn has a deep hatred for the Ambracians, but above all, he longs to return to his country.

The challenge facing the player-character (PC) is that Samuel the Healer is closely guarded and well hidden, and numerous assassination attempts have failed. The PC must therefore follow multiple leads to track Samuel down, as well as complete quests, fight enemies (and in some cases, engage in spiritual warfare), and solve puzzles in order to complete the mission.

Built with the Neverwinter Nights Aurora toolsets, *Calydon* uses conventional races, classes, abilities, and other rule sets from Neverwinter Nights. For example, players can manage weapons and items, gain experience and level up, explore the city areas and “sub” areas, embark on main as well as side quests, and interact in meaningful ways with the objects and NPCs of Romera. Towards the end of the game, players must also make significant choices that will have a direct effect on the ending of the game.

The themes, factions, settings, and events of the game are inspired by historical events which took place in the 1st century Roman Empire when Christianity was a new belief system amongst a complex array of other philosophies, religions, and secular factions. At this time, religious violence and oppression were common occurrences, not only in Rome but in many other regions under the dominion of the Roman empire. When people of certain religious belief fell out of favor with prevailing institutions, they often resorted to utmost secrecy to protect themselves and their families. Yet many such people also challenged or raised serious doubts about the status quo, often leading to intense debate, backlash, and violence. These are the types of themes which play a major role in the settings, character relationships, quests, and gameplay of *Calydon*.

3 Purpose and Organization of This Document

The purpose of this design document is to lay the conceptual foundation for the development and design of *Calydon* using the Neverwinter Nights™ Aurora toolset. As such, it provides a multifaceted view of the level design, gameplay mechanics, narrative design, and other key elements of the game's development. It describes the world in which the game takes place, the characters, the story structure, and other high-level requirements and specifications.

The remainder of document is divided into the following sections:

- *Section 4: Narrative Description of Opening Gameplay (aka "The Grabber")* – Describes the opening scene and suggests why players will be compelled to keep playing.
- *Section 5: Races, Characters, Factions, and Nationalities* – Describes the main characters and factions in the game.
- *Section 6: Story Structure* – Describes the order of events in the game using a process flow diagram and decision points.
- *Section 7: Interface* – Describes the user interface elements through which the player will interact with the game.
- *Section 8: Obstacles* – Describes the challenges the player must overcome to win the game.
- *Section 9: Level Walkthrough* – Describes the major levels of the game and the key components of those levels, such as important objects and mood and tone.
- *Section 10: Gameplay* – Describes the controls, effects on player, and other elements of the game mechanics. Also describes the different types of interaction the player will engage in, such as dialogue, exploration, and combat.
- *Section 11: Art* – Describes initial concepts for the visual design of the game.

- *Section 12: Audio Requirements* – Describes audio elements of the game, such as character sounds, NPC sounds, and music.

4 Narrative Description of Opening Gameplay (“The Grabber”)

You wake up in your prison cell, head throbbing. Stumbling to your cell door, you’re shocked to find that it’s open. You look around, bewildered, and see no guards in the vicinity. Walking to nearby cells, you quickly learn that the other prisoners are still locked in. When you question them, some quiver with fear, while others claim to have heard cries of death and the sound of monsters. All of them beg you to let them out, but of course you can do nothing without a key.

You go down the hall to the nearest juncture where a guard should be, and find it empty. You also find a spear and a shield. Arming yourself, you ascend one level and try to escape through the only exit. But the door is locked.

The only other way you can go is down, down into the dredges of the prison, down where they keep the magical beasts until they must be used for battle. You decide it’s your only hope of finding a way out.

So you return down from where you came. When you enter the lowest chamber where they keep the monsters, you’re attacked immediately and fight for your very life. After slaying the “boss” monster, you find what you’re looking for: a key. There is also a pool of blood nearby and the remnants of a cloak, and you surmise that one of the prison guards has been eaten alive.

You return to the uppermost level of the prison and exit through the door. And you emerge to find yourself surrounded by a squadron of archers and infantry.

That’s when Damien Carth, the Emperor’s right-hand man, approaches you and explains you’ve passed his test; you are good enough to be a killer. You are then escorted to Marcus Cicero, emperor of the Ambracian Empire, the greatest and most civilized nation on earth. And the emperor has a quest for you: to assassinate the man called Samuel the Healer, the leader of a new religious group called the Calydonians. Damien Carth explains that Samuel has been sowing division and hatred among religious factions in the city, leading to angry mobs, social upheaval, and acts of violence.

Why should you, of all people, be the one to do this? The emperor explains that Samuel is hard to find and all other assassination attempts have failed. In addition, barbarians attack the Ambracian Empire from without, and the Emperor is short on skilled warriors. Finally, and most importantly, the Emperor knows that you are a skilled rogue who earned a reputation during the Nyssian war for your stealth and ability to catch enemies unaware.

The Emperor then gives you two incentives: your freedom and the freedom of your sister. You accept. And then the real adventure begins.

5 Races, Characters, Factions, and Nationalities

5.1 Races

Calydon is based in a fantasy fiction universe where races of many exist: Humans, Elves, Dwarves, Gnomes, Half-Elves, Halflings, Humans, and Half-Orcs. Although these races do not coexist peacefully in all parts of the world, they coexist in relative harmony within the borders of the Ambracian Empire. Humans are essentially the race in power in the city of Romera, though elves and dwarves and the other races can travel freely and peacefully through the city, and often occupy positions of great power and influence in Ambracia.

5.2 Characters

The characters described below are the people with whom the PC interacts the most. They are significant in terms of their relevance to the plot and/or their roles in helping or hindering the PC in achieving his goals.

Note: This high-level design document is only intended to give an initial view into the characters. As development of the game moves forward, this document will be updated to capture decisions about character relationships and additional categories such as their skills, ability scores (only applicable to protagonist), and physical attributes (e.g., height, weight, body type, eye color, etc.).

5.2.1 Brynn Harrowmage (Protagonist)

Category	Description
Race	Human
Class	Rogue
Alignment	Neutral Good
Biography	Brynn is the youngest son of King Faldoran, ruler of the country of Nyssia, which is several hundred miles north of Ambracia, the country where the game is set. When the Ambracians invaded his homeland, he fought valiantly alongside his father. At the end of the war, he was imprisoned rather than executed so that he could be used as leverage in the event that his people started a revolt. Brynn has been imprisoned for two years. In the course of that time, the Emperor who conquered the Nyssian people is dead and his successor, Marcus Cicero, is in power. Brynn does not know this initially, however, since he has been virtually cut off from the outside world. In fact, he is convinced the Ambracians have forgotten he is even a prisoner. This is not too far from the truth. Only several people in all of the city of Romera know who Brynn is. <Rest of the write-up is redacted>

Category	Description
Nationality	Nyssian
General Disposition	Witty, experienced, charming, strong, tactical, stealthy

5.2.2 Damien Carth

Category	Description
Race	Human
Class	Cleric
Alignment	Neutral Evil
Biography	Damien is the right-hand man of the Emperor and Minister of the City, a job which involves maintaining order, justice, and peace within the city. He is a member of the secular faction known as the Lanterns, and he collaborates often with the wizard called Odyssea gather intelligence about other religious factions in order to secretly oppose them. <Rest of the write-up is redacted>
Nationality	Ambracian
General Disposition	Stern, calculating, judgmental, cunning, ambitious, brooding

5.2.3 Emperor Marcus Cicero

Category	Description
Race	Human
Class	Fighter
Alignment	Lawful Neutral
Biography	Marcus Cicero is the emperor of the Ambracian Empire and king of the city of Romera. He is an intelligent and resourceful leader, and he is extremely knowledgeable of the law and the constitution. He is also a shrewd politician and capable military leader. He is not a religious person except to promote the identity of his people. Above all, he is a humanist who believes that humans are capable of creating systems of order and justice. He also is a firm believer in aesthetics, and therefore loves the pleasures of life one would call "ordinary," such as art, music, love, and games. If he could abolish religion, he would, but until that time comes, he desires people to have the freedom they want to express themselves. Although he acts like a realist, when it comes to what the law can accomplish, he is an idealist. He really does think the law and reason are the answers to all human suffering.
Nationality	Ambracian
General Disposition	Strong, idealistic, intelligent, shrewd

5.2.4 Isabella Harrowmage

Category	Description
Race	Human
Class	Druid
Alignment	Lawful Good
Biography	Isabella is the beautiful daughter of King Faldoran Harrowmage. She is the oldest of three sisters in the family (her two younger sisters are twins and were mere babes who still live with their mother in their home land). In the game, she is 13 years old—seven years younger than her brother Brynn. <Rest of the write-up is redacted>
Nationality	Nyssian
General Disposition	Compassionate, courageous, intelligent, well-spoken

5.2.5 Delilah Elmrock

Category	Description
Race	Elf
Class	Rogue
Alignment	Neutral Good
Biography	Delilah Elmrock is one of the best prostitutes at the brothel known as the King's Dove, where she draws a clientele of respectable Ambracian citizens, one of whom used to be Master Lucius Algernon. Hers is a sad story, however. She was once happily married, but she caught her husband having an affair. To even the score, she had an affair with another man. <Rest of the write-up is redacted>
Nationality	Ambracian
General Disposition	Graceful, intelligent, bitter, witty

5.2.6 Master Lucius Algernon

Category	Description
Race	Human
Class	Wizard
Alignment	Chaotic Good
Biography	Master Lucius Algernon is an eccentric professor of Symbology at Light Gate University. He is extremely smart and inquisitive, but he is not particularly clean or organized. His students often find him absent minded, in fact. Without

Category	Description
	the help of his assistant, Ralf, his office and library would be a mess. Still, he has done much research on the symbols and religions of different cultures, and he is widely-reputed for his books on the subject. <Rest of the write-up is redacted>
General Disposition	Boisterous, jovial, inquisitive, intelligent, eccentric

5.2.7 Samuel the Healer

Category	Description
Race	Human
Class	Monk
Alignment	Lawful Good
Biography	Samuel the Healer is known for being one of the few remaining disciples of the Calydonian faith to have seen and touched Calydon, the savior who founded the faith. As the name suggest, Samuel became well known for miraculously healing people of maladies such as blindness and deafness, for compassion, and for possessing an incredible amount of altruism. <Rest of the write-up is redacted>
Nationality	Meridianite
General Disposition	Kind, wise, joyful, courageous, patient, loving, gentle

5.2.8 Mace Killian

Category	Description
Race	Human
Class	Fighter
Alignment	Lawful Evil
Biography	Mace is the head of the violent and fanatical group of Calydonians known as the Vigil. Although he believes himself to be doing the righteous work of God, he is in fact doing much harm to the faith. He has gone so far as to orchestrate the deaths of people who have so much as threatened to oppose the Calydonians. <Rest of the write-up is redacted>
Nationality	Meridianite
General Disposition	Cunning, strong, gruff, shrewd

5.2.9 Odyssea Thyme

Category	Description
Race	Elf
Class	Wizard
Alignment	Lawful Evil
Biography	Odyssea Thyme is the head of the secular faction known as the Lanterns. She is a studious and extremely knowledgeable wizard. Indeed, she was the first elf ever to attain so high a social rank in Ambracian society. <Rest of the write-up is redacted>
Nationality	Ambracian
General Disposition	Cunning, ambitious, intelligent, foul tempered, bitter

5.3 Factions

Factions in *Calydon* are politically-, religiously-, or secularly- based power groups. The word “factions” is not used in the game itself; it is simply a way for the designers and developers to organize the characters and groups in the game. There are three main categories of factions in *Calydon*: religious factions, political factions, and secular factions. Most if not all of the characters in the game would identify themselves with one or more of these factions.

Note: As the game design progresses, more specifications will be captured for these factions in a narrative design document, such as each faction’s leader(s), group’s objectives, powers, fears, symbols, and infrastructure.

5.3.1 Religious Factions

5.3.1.1 The Calydonians

Description	In-Game Characters
Based on the life, teachings, and death of a man named Calydon, the Calydonians are former Meridians who believe that a savior has indeed come. This savior, however, did not come to establish a political state, but to die for the sins of the world, providing forgiveness for all who put their faith in him. The name of this savior is Calydon. Calydon claimed not just to be a prophet, but to be God himself in the flesh. His purpose was to save the world of its sins. Calydon was executed by other Meridians for his outrageous claims. However, his body is no longer found in his grave. Followers of Calydon say that he rose from the dead, ascended into heaven, and will return to redeem the world.	- Trisha Elmrock, daughter of Delilah Elmrock - Samuel the Healer - Isabella Harrowmage - Minor NPCs encountered in the Imperial Palace, the Forum, and Light Gate University.

5.3.1.2 The Vigil

Description	In-Game Characters
The Vigil is a group of Calydonian extremists who are willing to resort to violence to spread their faith and protect their own. While they hold to the basic tenets of the Calydonian faith, they are intensely ritualistic, they assign great significance to relics, and they believe that if they do not act strong and resist persecution, others will simply take advantage of them. The player later discovers that the Vigil is responsible for taking Samuel the Healer and putting him under “house arrest” so that no one can take him and assassinate him.	• Mace Killian • Master Lucius Algernon • Minor NPCs encountered in the Necropolis, the catacombs, and other locations in the city.

5.3.1.3 The Meridians

Description	In-Game Characters
The Meridians call themselves God's chosen people. They have the law of God and made a covenant to follow its rules until their Savior comes to establish a perfect kingdom of justice and love. The Meridian faith forms the foundation of the Calydonian. However, the Meridians do not believe Calydon was God, but just another prophet.	• Minor NPCs encountered in the Imperial Palace, the Forum, and Light Gate University.

5.3.1.4 The Suns

Description	In-Game Characters
The Suns are believers of Sun, the chief god of the Ambracian people. They are a polytheistic body of believers, and they have gods for the seasons, for emotions such as love, and for the elements of the earth. The Suns have many rituals and ceremonies and temples, as well as a body of priests in positions of power throughout the Ambracian empire.	• Marcus Cicero • Damien Carth • Odyssea Thyme • Minor NPCs encountered in the Imperial Palace, the Forum, and Light Gate University.

5.3.2 Political Factions

5.3.2.1 The Optimates

Description	In-Game Characters
The Optimates are politicians who generally represent the interests of the aristocratic class and push for more power for the Senate. They tend to be too bureaucratic for their own good. However, they have a thorough knowledge of the constitution and generally good at making effective laws.	• Marcus Cicero • Damien Carth • Minor NPCs encountered in the Imperial Palace, the Forum, and Light Gate University.

5.3.2.2 The Populares

Description	In-Game Characters
The Populares are politicians who represent the interests of the people. They push for a more democratic system of government. They tend to be less organized than the Optimates, and they like to move quickly to get things done.	Minor NPCs encountered in the Imperial Palace, the Forum and Light Gate University.

5.3.3 Secular Factions

5.3.3.1 The Lanterns

Description	In-Game Characters
This is a guild of scholars, philosophers, lawyers, priests, theologians, wizards, and other men and women whose profession is primarily intellectual or focused on the arcane. Generally speaking, they represent the interests of knowledge workers, and continually seek to increase the stature of those who work with scrolls and letters.	- Damien Carth - Master Lucius Algernon - Odyssea Thyme - Minor NPCs encountered in the Imperial Palace, the Forum and Light Gate University.

5.3.3.2 The Fielders

Description	In-Game Characters
This is a guild of skilled laborers, such as farmers, fisherman, wine-makers, and other craftsmen who produce raw materials. Their agendas are to promote their interests and products before the Emperor and the Senate, mainly for the purpose of ensuring they are able to sell their products locally and abroad at the highest possible value.	Minor NPCs encountered in the Imperial Palace, the Forum and Light Gate University.

5.3.3.3 The Craft Masters

Description	In-Game Characters
This is a guild of professional craftsman and business owners, such as dyers, blacksmiths, architects, plumbers, and masons. Their agendas, like the Fielders, are explicitly economic in nature—i.e., to promote their interests and skills before the Emperor and the Senate, and to ensure trade is thriving.	Minor NPCs encountered in the Imperial Palace, the Forum and Light Gate University.

5.4 Nationalities

Nationalities in Calydon refers to a character's ethnic background. Most of the characters in the game are of Ambracian descent, but other nationalities exist.

5.4.1 Ambracian

Description	In-Game Characters
Any legal citizen of the country of Ambracia is an Ambracian. This includes the majority of inhabitants in the city of Romera. Any race of people (dwarves, elves, etc.) can become Ambracian. Many races, however, are under the dominion of the Ambracian empire but choose not to become Ambracian citizens, as it involves a rejection of their former identities. Ambracians are generally very pragmatic people with a penchant for law and order.	• Emperor Marcus Cicero • Damien Carth • Master Lucius Algernon • Odyssea Thyme • Minor NPCs encountered in the Imperial Palace, the Forum and Light Gate University.

5.4.2 Meridianite

Description	In-Game Characters
Most if not all people who are of the Meridian faith are Meridianites—that is, they were born in the country of Meridia or are descended from people who did. Thus, being a Meridianite is an ethnic as well as religious identity. Due to their religion, Meridianites follow strict moral codes and dietary laws. Sacrificing animals to their only God is an important regular ritual for them.	• Samuel the Healer • Mace Killian

5.4.3 Nyssian

Description	In-Game Characters
Nyssians are inhabitants of the country of Nyssia, which is several hundred miles north of Ambracia. Though Nyssians are considered barbarians by the Ambracians, they are a culture with rich, well-developed traditions. Their land is filled with forests and mountains, and they practice a polytheistic faith, the chief god of which is called El Diah.	• Brynn Harrowmage • Isabella Harrowmage

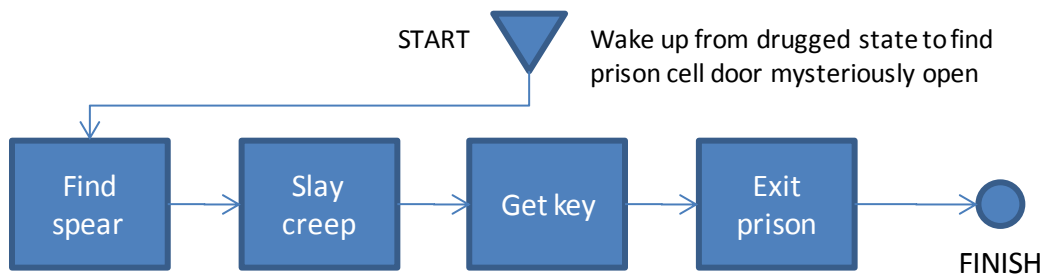
6 Story Structure

The story structure has seven main chapters or parts, each of which is illustrated by the activity diagrams below. Within each diagram, the structure is broken down by major activities or quests the player must complete to beat the game. Note that as a result of branching narrative, Part 7 has two subparts. Also note that between quests, the PC generally has an unlimited amount of time to explore unlocked levels or locations.

6.1 Part 1: Escape from Prison Darkhenge

Prison Darkhenge is where the game starts. The PC wakes up one day, and the door to the cell is mysteriously open. The PC exits the prison and must find a key to unlock the uppermost door of the prison.

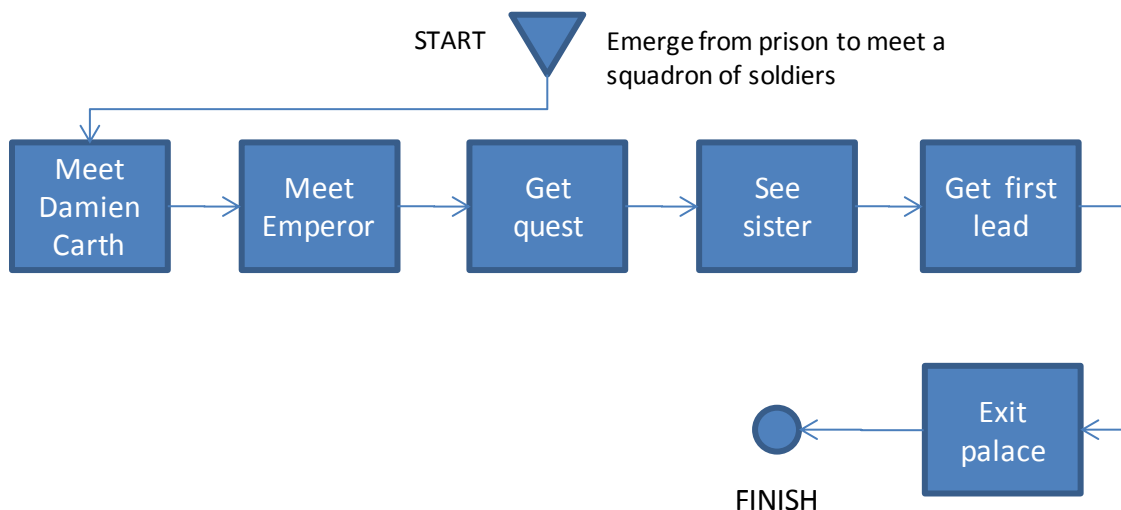
Figure 1: Activity Diagram for escaping from Prison Darkhenge



6.2 Part 2: Get assassination quest from Emperor Marcus

After escaping from the prison, the PC emerges into the palace bailey to find a squadron of soldiers waiting for him. They escort the PC to Emperor Marcus, who then gives the PC the quest to assassinate Samuel the Healer, the living leader of the Calydonians, in exchange for the freedom of the PC and the PC's sister.

Figure 2: Activity Diagram for getting quest from Emperor Marcus



6.3 Part 3

<REDACTED>

6.4 *Part 4*

<REDACTED>

6.5 *Part 5*

<REDACTED>

6.6 *Part 6*

<REDACTED>

6.7 *Part 7*

<REDACTED>

7 Interface

The interface through which the player interacts with the game is the same interface used in Neverwinter Nights. This section briefly describes the Radial Menu, the Main Gameplay Screen, and Hotkey Commands.

7.1 The Radial Menu

The PC can display the Radial Menu by pressing the right mouse button on their character or by right-clicking away from their character on any point in the Main Gameplay Screen. When it appears, it shows a ring of possible actions that player can perform. The player clicks the left mouse button to select an action.

7.2 The Main Gameplay Screen

The built-in Main Gameplay Screen of the Neverwinter Nights toolset has multiple distinct sections, as depicted in Figure 4.

Figure 3: Radial Menu



Figure 4: Interface that Calydon will use is from the Neverwinter Nights Aurora Toolset



The table below describes the primary sections of the Main Gameplay Screen.

No.	Name	Description
1	Character Portrait	Displays picture of the main character.
2	Options Box	Gives access to different screens needed to control the character, such as the journal, map, and inventory.
3	Chat Window	Displays messages from in-game events and other NPCs.
4	Chat Entry Bar	Allows the player to type chat messages. Not applicable for this game.
5	Quickbar	Gives the player quick access functions such as spells and items. Each cell in the quickbar has a corresponding hotkey. Players can drag inventory items and spells to the cells in the quickbar.
6	Compass	Indicates the direction the character is facing.
7	Status Bar	Displays any special effects, such as a cast spell or a negative effect inflicted on the PC by another.
8	Inventory	Displays the character's equipment. This panel is not always active; it is shown here for explanatory purposes.
9	Main Gameplay Screen	The main portion of the screen (obviously) where the action

No.	Name	Description
		takes place.

7.3 Hotkey Commands and Panels

Players will be able to click in the interface *as well as* use hotkey commands to bring up the interface panels listed in the table below. These are the panels provided by the Neverwinter Nights interface. (For a list of the corresponding hotkeys for the panels, see Section 10.1: Controller Configuration.)

Interface Element	Description
Character Panel	Displays statistics and abilities of the character.
Skills Sub Panel	Displays all the character's skills and modifiers.
Feats Sub Panel	Displays information about a special abilities granted by the character's class and race.
Inventory Panel	Displays the character's equipment.
Spells Panel	Displays the character's spellbook panel and spell preparation panel.
Conversation Panel	Displays portrait of the character that PC is talking with, as well as response options.
Map Panel	Displays aerial (top-down) view of the area the PC is in. Expands as the player explores an area and indicates current location.
Journal Panel	Displays the status of the PC's quest.
Stores Panel	Displays store items on the left side and player's inventory on the right side.
Options Panel	Lets the player customize game options to suit his or her playing style. Includes controls for video, sound, game options, etc.

8 Obstacles

The main obstacles the player must overcome to win the game include the enemies and puzzles listed in the tables below.

8.1 Enemies

Enemy	Description
Warrior	Warriors of the fanatical Calydonian group called the Vigil that the PC must fight at key points in the game.
Gladiators	Dwarves, Humans, Elves, Half-Orcs, Gnomes, or Halflings who are gladiatorial fighters of the Ambracian Colosseo.
Magical Beasts	Gargoyles, Stirges, and other beasts known as "Creeps" and encountered in the lower levels of Prison Darkhenge.
Aberrations	Ettercaps, Hook Horrors, and other aberrations the PC must fight when

Enemy	Description
	engaging in spiritual warfare.
Undead	Ghouls, Mohrgs, Wights, Shadow Fiends, and other undead creatures the PC must fight when engaging in spiritual warfare.

8.2 Puzzles

<REDACTED>

9 Level Walkthrough

The game has eight major areas and multiple subareas, each of which are described below in the order in which they are encountered in the game.

Note(s): This high-level design document is only intended to give an initial view into what the areas will look like or contain. More detailed design documents for each level will be created to capture and provide more detailed specifications, such as tile set properties, load screens, and the like.

9.1 Prison Darkhenge

Category	Description
Sub Areas (if applicable)	Prison Darkhenge has three levels: a main level where the guards stay; a second level where the humanoid prisoners stay; and a third level where monsters are kept.
Key Objects	Spear, prison key
Unique Things About Location	The prison is relatively dark, but it is very symmetrical and has carvings of monsters inside of it. It has a stream running through it at the bottom level, since it is positioned on the edge of a river. It contains cells for monsters called “Creeps” that the Ambracian Imperial Army keeps captive.
Mood / Tone	The mood should be creepy and dank. Sounds of dripping water and echoing halls and groaning, suffering prisoners. In lower levels, the sound of monster growls is appropriate.
Time of Day / Weather	Morning
Major Characters and How They Develop in Level	Brynn Harrowmage is introduced. His hatred for the Ambracians and background as a POW is revealed.
Level Boss	Trolls and Ogres are enemies in the lowermost level. The boss is a talking Satyr.
Plot info to reveal	The Ambracian armies capture and employ monsters or “Creeps” to wage their wars. This is done with the help of the faction known as the Lanterns, which has wizards and sorcerers among its members.
Setup for Future Level	None.

9.2 The Imperial Palace (aka “The White Crown”)

Category	Description
Sub Areas (if applicable)	The Imperial Palace includes Prison Darkhenge, the Palace Bailey, and the Throne Room.
Key Objects	Sword, gold (for bribes), new Ambracian garb, first healing potion.
Unique Things About Location	The palace is the seat of the most powerful nation on the planet at the time. It should therefore contain, among other things, memorials of its past, such as statues of the generals and emperors who made it great, as well as springs and gardens for the nobles who live there.
Mood / Tone	One half of the palace is militaristic, as it hosts the palace guard. The other half should come across as regal and architecturally impressive, as it houses the throne room and the Senate.
Time of Day / Weather	Morning
Major Characters and How They Develop in Level	Damien Carth, Emperor Marcus Cicero, Empress Arya Cicero, and Brynn's sister Isabella are all introduced in this level. The PC learns of Brynn's deepest motives to free his sister and return to his homeland. The PC also learns of the Emperor's motive to see his city become a beacon of civilization, reason, and order. In meeting Damien Carth, however, the PC also gets a sense of the evil people in power.
Level Boss, Thugs, and Other Enemies	At the end of the game when the PC returns to this level, thugs include palace guards, and the boss is Odyssea Thyme. Odyssea is only a boss if the player chooses to side with the Calydonians and lets Simon the Healer live.
Plot or quest info to reveal	The main quest is received in this level (i.e., the quest to assassinate Samuel the Healer, who has been accused of fomenting religious violence, intolerance, and strife).

9.3 The City of Romera

<REDACTED>

9.4 The King's Dove

<REDACTED>

9.5 Colosseo

<REDACTED>

9.6 Light Gate University

<REDACTED>

9.7 The Necropolis (aka City Cemetery)

<REDACTED>

9.8 Calydonian Household

<REDACTED>

9.9 City Catacombs

<REDACTED>

10 Gameplay

10.1 Controller Configuration

The default controller configuration is the same as the Neverwinter Nights keyboard commands.

Control Category	Key	Mouse
Rotate Camera Left	Left Arrow	Move mouse all the way left
Rotate Camera	Right Arrow	Move mouse all the way right
Zoom In	Up Arrow	Mouse wheel forward
Zoom Out	Down Arrow	Mouse wheel backward
Zoom In Full	Home	Mouse wheel forward
Zoom Out Full	End	Mouse wheel backward
Pitch Camera Up	Page Up	Move mouse all the way up
Pitch Camera Down	Page Down	Move mouse all the way down
Camera Up Full	Insert	Hold mouse all the way up
Camera Down Full	Delete	Hold mouse all the way down
Step Left	Q	Left click in Main Gameplay Screen
Step Right	E	Left click in Main Gameplay Screen
Forward Run	W	Left click in Main Gameplay Screen
Back	S	Left click in Main Gameplay Screen
Turn Left	A	Left click in Main Gameplay Screen
Turn Right	D	Left click in Main Gameplay Screen
Inventory	I	Click Options Box or Radial Menu
Quick Chat	V	--
Journal	J	Click Options Box or Radial Menu
Character Sheet	C	Click Options Box or Radial Menu

Control Category	Key	Mouse
Spell Book	B	Click Options Box or Radial Menu
Map	M	Click Options Box or Radial Menu
PVP Panel	P	--
Options	O	Click Options Box
Quick Inspect	Tab	Click Radial Menu
Hide/Show GUI	H	--
Quick Save	G	--
Pause	Spacebar	--
Tool Tips	I	--

10.2 Character Actions

The following table describes the actions that the PC will be able to perform, as well as rules that the game will use to impose penalties or bonuses. These are based on the built-in controls and rule set of the Aurora Toolset.

Interaction Category	Description
Movement	The PC will play the game from a 3-D third person perspective. As shown in the controller configuration, the character will be able to run forward, back, and so on. There are many factors which affect movement, however. • Characters cannot run when they are in stealth mode • Characters cannot run when they are in detect mode • Lightly-encumbered characters cannot run • Heavily-encumbered characters cannot run and also have a 50% movement penalty
Character Interactions	The PC has a number of options in terms of interacting with other non-player characters (NPCs). These interactions are defined by the type of NPC the PC encounters. • The PC can initiate dialogue with the following types of NPCs to obtain quests, items, and information: Neutral, Friendly, and Invulnerable NPCs. Some NPCs may be of the type Busy, in which case the PC cannot interact with them until they finish their task. • The PC must fight a number of NPCs and monsters to progress through the game. Hostile NPCs will attack the PC by default. Neutral NPCs, if attacked, will become hostile and attack the PC. • Some NPCs are Invulnerable and cannot be attacked, since they are critical to advancing the plot.
Combat	Below is a sampling of the combat-related rules in the game. Combat typically happens through the Radial Menu and Quickbar controls. • The PC can invoke the Radial Menu on an NPC. Any option that the PC chooses will be directed at that NPC.

Interaction Category	Description
	The PC can select put combat items in the Quickbar, such as spells, weapons, and special attacks. The PC can then select the item and then choose an object to be targeted.
Weapons	The player will be able to acquire weapons such as spears, swords, or daggers in order to defeat the enemies that are encountered. The type of weapon the player acquires will determine what types of attacks they can perform. There are many weapons and weapon properties that come with the Aurora Toolset. Weapons are a type of equipment the PC can acquire. For more details on equipment, see the Equipment category below.
Equipment	The player will be able to acquire equipment, magic items, and/or treasure in a number of ways: - Looting corpses - Opening crates and chests - Pick pocketing - Purchasing items from stores and merchants - Receiving items as rewards after finishing quests In terms of the <i>types</i> of equipment the PC will be able to acquire, the Aurora Toolset provides several major categories and multiple sub-categories, as listed below. <i>Calydon</i> will include equipment from every one of these categories at some point in the game. - Armor – Everything from clothing to heavy armor to tower shields. - Weapons – Everything from small one-handed weapons to large weapons that only giants can wield, as well as weapons for melee and ranged attacks. - Miscellaneous Items – Amulets, rings, bags, etc. - Magic Items – Magic weapons, potions, scrolls, rods, etc. - Lore – A spell or skill which lets you identify unidentified items. - Loot – Armor, weapons, etc., found while completing adventures.

10.3 Exploration

The player will be able explore areas in *Calydon* in a free roaming manner. That is, the PC will have an open environment through which to follow leads, find quests, initiate conversations with NPCs, get information about the game world, and fight enemies. There will be “doors” separating the major levels or areas from each other (e.g., there will be doors between the gates of the city and the surrounding countryside, or between the city streets and entrances to major buildings). These doors cause a pause in the game and a load screen to appear to allow the next area to load.

In terms of finding objects during exploration, there are a variety of options and scripts that come with the Aurora Toolset, such as opening chests and looting dead bodies. Also, as the PC explores certain areas, they may set off triggers

which spawn monsters or some type of enemy. An example of areas where such “encounters” will occur include:

- Exploring dungeons or catacombs is likely to trigger encounters with magical beasts, aberrations, undead, etc.
- Walking through narrow alleys in the city is likely to trigger encounters with bandits and assassins.
- Walking through the open fields surrounding the city is likely to trigger encounters with hostile animals

10.4 Interface

Please see Section 7: Interface for a description of the interface.

10.5 Direct Effects on the Character

Effects on the character can take the form of spells, damage, combat bonuses or penalties, or movement penalties. The State Bar of the interface displays the effects on a character. The table below summarizes some the high-level effects that *Calydon* will include as part of its gameplay. The way these effects work will be determined for the most part by the built-in rules of the Aurora Toolset.

Effect Category	Description
Health	Following the Neverwinter Nights rule set, health is the number of a hit points the PC has. As explained below under the “Level Up” category, players can increase their hit points by gaining levels.
Damage	When the PC engages in combat, an enemy can make an attack that hurts the PC. Likewise, the PC makes attacks which damage the enemy. Technically, these interactions are called attack rolls. If an attack roll exceeds or is equal to a character’s Armor Class, then a hit is scored. The PC can also inflict and receive damage by way of spells. See the spells category below.
Effects from Spells and Magic Items	Spells and magic items are the perhaps the most frequent cause of direct effects on the PC. The Neverwinter Nights rule set specifies a wide range of game effects which can be applied to the PC. Below is a sampling of the effects that will be made possible via spells and magic items in <i>Calydon</i>. • Ability Score • Blindness • Damage Modified • Entangled • Paralysis • Spell Resistance
Replenishment	The easiest way for a PC to replenish hit points is by resting. This is an option in the Radial Menu. Other ways to replenish include: healing potions, healing spells, and the Heal skill.
Character Death	The PC loses hit points when damaged. When the PC’s hit points reach zero, the PC dies. When the PC dies, the player can choose to re-spawn,

Effect Category	Description
	but they will lose experience and gold in doing so.
Level Up	As the PC progresses throughout the game, they gain levels that grant them access to more skills, spells, and special abilities. The primary way the PC levels up is by earning experience points (XP). XP is mainly earned as a reward for defeating enemies and solving puzzles. The Neverwinter Nights rules surrounding XP and gaining levels include the following: • The PC earns XP immediately after defeating a monster • The PC earns XP after finishing a quest or adventure • The PC gains a level when enough XP has been earned

11 Art

11.1 Character Designs

The characters in *Calydon* will be based on existing 2-D character portraits, 3-D models, and blueprints in the Creatures palette of the Aurora Toolset. There is a Creature Wizard tool which lets designers specify unique properties for a creature, but the wizard is limited to the models within the game. Built-in content will be used as much as possible to keep the scope of the project manageable.

Some customization may be done with the help of the NWN Viewer and BioWare's Hapak Editor, which allow users to view and browse NWN resource files, as well as add custom content files to supplement or override the game's content. Any custom 2-D portraits must conform to the following specifications:

- Be save in uncompressed, 24-bit, Targa Bitmap (TGA) format
- Be saved in four different sizes (huge, large, medium, small) in order to be used in the character creation screen, character sheet, main screen portrait, and pop-up dialogue

Note: These are initial high-level specifications. Other detailed specifications, such as file-naming conventions and required image dimensions, will be written and documented in a matrix format as the project progresses.

In the case of 3-D modeling, a tool such as Autodesk 3ds Max or an image editing tool such as Photoshop will be necessary. Using 3ds Max will require MAX Scripts to export and/or import model files. Moreover, there is a suite of community-built scripting tools (MDL Plug-in Suite 1.0) that enables the import of BioWare models into 3ds Max 4 or 5, which can then be used to manipulate the models and export them as ASCII files.

More detailed designs for the characters will be developed as the game design progresses, but the table below defines some high-level physical attributes of the characters.

Character	Physical / Visual Characteristics
Brynn Harrowmage	Young (early 20s), lean, long dirty blonde hair, gray eyes
Damien Carth	Middle aged, lanky, long red hair, spectacles, green eyes
Emperor Marcus Cicero	Middle aged, lean, broad shouldered, blonde cropped hair, blonde beard and mustache
Isabella Harrowmage	Young (early teens), slender, long auburn hair, green eyes
Delilah Elmrock	Middle aged, slender, dark skinned, long dark hair, purple eyes
Master Lucius Algernon	Old, dwarven, long and curly red hair, red bushy chops, enormously fat
Mace Killian	Middle aged, wears a turban to conceal bald head, black bushy
Odyssea Thyme	Old, elfish, long gray and white hair, fair, thin, tall
Samuel the Healer	Very old, short white hair, wrinkled features, slight hunch back,

11.2 Weapon / Item Concept Art

The weapons and items in *Calydon* will be based on the existing blueprints in the Items palette of the Aurora Toolset. More detailed designs for items such as swords, spears, books, necklaces, etc., will be developed as the game design progresses. Built-in content will be used as much as possible to keep the scope of the project manageable.

Any custom design or modeling done for the weapons or items in *Calydon* will draw inspiration from both the medieval and Roman Empire periods of history, while also trying as much as possible to build upon or modify existing models in the toolset to minimize the level of effort. A considerable amount of customization can be done simply by using the Item Wizard in the Aurora Engine. This wizard allows, for example, manipulation of values such as a weapon's model and color.

For more in-depth custom model creation or editing, the appropriate file must first be exported or extracted from the toolset, opened and edited with a 3-D modeling tool, and then saved in a format that can be exported to and read by the toolset. If such in-depth custom modeling is necessary, 3ds Max will most likely be the software program of choice for the task, since there is considerable support and documentation on using 3ds Max in conjunction with the Aurora toolset.

11.3 World Concept Art

The Aurora Toolset provides a number of pre-built tilesets, each of which comes with its own unique features and terrains. The following built-in tilesets will be especially relevant to *Calydon*: Castle Interior, City Exterior, City Interior, Dungeon, Sewers, and Rural. For example, within the city exterior tileset, the following terrain objects will be relevant to the design of the city of Romera:

- Features
 - Fountains at key locations in residential areas and markets
 - Houses in all wards
 - Markets in both the Colosseo and South East Ward
 - Plazas near the Forum, Colosseo, and Palace
 - Slum houses for the South East Ward
- Groups
 - The Arena for the Colosseo
 - Good, Bad, and Neutral Temples for the different religious groups
 - Wizard Towers for magic workers who are a part of the Lanterns faction
 - Slate Building to signify a religious house of worship
- Terrains
 - Bridges for the western and eastern entrances of the city
 - Walls for the border of the city and the Imperial Palace

12 Audio Requirements

The sound blueprints in the Aurora Toolset are grouped under six major categories: Animals, Civilization, Magical, Nature, People, and Weather. Depending on the mood and tone of each level, the game will draw a variety of blueprints from these categories. The table below lists an initial sampling of relevant people sounds for six of the levels in *Calydon*:

Level	Relevant People Sounds from the Aurora Toolset
Prison Darkhenge	Coughs, crying, crypt moans, pain cries, shrieks, despairing men, etc.
Imperial Palace	Noble laugh, nobles talk, etc.
City of Romera	Beggar calls, city yells, customer yells, evangelist calls, rowdy tavern, etc.
King's Dove	Prostitute calls, laughs, talking nobles
Colosseo	Cheers men, cheers women, shrieks, screams, cheers commoner group, etc.
Light Gate University	Taunting noble group, commoners talk outside, etc.

More detailed audio requirements and decisions will be documented as the game design progresses. Custom sounds may also be developed by adding .wav files or .bmu files to the appropriate file directory and selecting them for use within the module.

12.1 Character Sounds

Although voice acting is out of the scope for this game, there are multiple voicesets that come built-in with the Aurora Engine. These include voicesets for males and females from each of the races available in the toolset. A voiceset can be assigned to any given NPC, and the game engine will automatically emit sounds from this set based on triggers within the game, such as when engaging in combat. Such sounds can also be activated when the PC clicks the appropriate buttons in the Radial Menu.

12.2 Enemy / NPC Sounds

The enemy and NPC sounds will be similar to the character sounds—i.e., limited to built-in sounds of the Aurora Engine, such as battle cries and cheering.

12.3 Music

The Aurora Toolset comes with a wide range of built-in music properties for each tileset. These music files will be leveraged as much as possible to keep the scope of the game manageable. Any custom music created for the game must be in the BioWare Music Unit (BMU) format and then added to the “music” directory under the directory where *Neverwinter Nights* is installed. Or, .wav files can be created and added to the module using a hak pak.

Custom music will be explored as an option especially for the King’s Dove brothel and the Light Gate University areas, which are a little more unique than the generic areas, groups, and features available in the toolset.

12.4 Vocal Recording

This is currently not applicable, since vocal recording is outside the scope and budget of this game. However, the script for *Calydon* will document the intended tone and/or inflection for vocal delivery of each line of dialogue. This is to prepare for the possibility that the game is well received and plans are made to produce it on a more professional scale.